

Prokuro Subscription Pricing v1 — Reviewed Decision Brief

Date: 2026-08-14 · Status: **LOCKED** · Do not reopen pricing. Do not change \$149 / \$399.

1. Executive summary

Keep Growth at \$149/mo and Scale at \$399/mo. Add a real Free tier with hard volume caps. Package on live BOMs plus a monthly line cap — not seats as the SKU, and not metered overages. Free proves the analyst on one small board; Growth is the working buyer (quotes); Scale is the desk (volume and orders when enabled). Enterprise stays sales-led and off the public grid. Do not advertise Free until caps, paid-priority Digi-Key, Free sync exclusion, and 402s are live.

2. Public tiers

FREE \$0 No Stripe product Run one real board through the analyst. Pay for volume or purchasing.	GROWTH \$149/mo \$1,490/yr (10× monthly) For the buyer who owns a handful of live boards and needs distributor quotes.	SCALE \$399/mo \$3,990/yr (10× monthly) For a small procurement team: more boards, purchasing, year of history.
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Commercial gate already correct: Free **can_purchase=false**; quotes and orders require a paid active plan. Missing today: real Free semantics and volume limits. Growth and Scale are the same SKU shape at two prices — differentiate by limits and value, not by cutting dollars. Do not degrade Free analysis quality; cap volume. Quotes and orders stay fully off Free.

LIMIT	FREE	GROWTH	SCALE
Seats (ceiling)	1	2	5
Active BOMs	1	10	50
Max lines / BOM	100	500	2,000
BOM lines / month	300	2,500	15,000
Analyses / month	3	20	100
Quotes / month	0	25	200
Orders / month (when enabled)	0	10	50
can_purchase	false	true	true
Retention (days)	14	90	365
Concurrent analyses	1	1	3
New unique MPN lookups / day	100	500	2,000
Include in daily Digi-Key sync	no	yes	yes
LLM / Bedrock	off	off until enabled	off until enabled

Definitions: lines/month = sum of lines in each analysis job (re-analyze counts). Active BOM = un-archived, inside retention. Seats are a ceiling; today 1 Cognito user = 1 seat.

3. Why keep \$149 / \$399

The stickers are already in the right B2B neighborhood. SiliconExpert's public BOM Manager starter is **\$250/mo for 1 user and 1 BOM up to 500 parts**. Prokuro Growth is under that price with more live BOMs and quotes. Cutting to \$99 is a consumer reflex. Do not raise dollars while Digi-Key ordering is off and Growth/Scale are undifferentiated in product. Raise value on Scale (seats, 2,000-line boards, orders), not the list price. No other competitor dollar figures are used here — Z2Data and Nexar do not publish list prices we will treat as facts.

4. Packaging (locked)

Sell live BOMs + a hard monthly line cap. One sentence: you pay for how many BOMs you keep live; we cap lines so API spend cannot explode. Seats are a ceiling (1 / 2 / 5), not the SKU. Hard 402 + upgrade, not overages.

Rejected for v1: seat-primary packaging (cost is unique MPNs and analyses, not heads; hardware teams share logins) and usage overages (no meter yet; B2B buyers hate surprise invoices). Revisit overages only after 90 days of real histograms, and only for Enterprise.

5. Abuse and AWS explosion controls

Digi-Key enrichment is globally capped at 1,000 lookups/day and 120/min. Unlimited Free plus daily sync of every prokuro-parts key is how a few novel industrial BOMs starve paid customers. AWS dollars at 0–200 accounts are almost entirely lights-on (~\$50–100/mo, base ~\$70). Uncapped Free is a **quota** risk, not primarily a dollar risk.

Free kill-switches (must be live before advertising Free)

- `can_purchase=false` — no quotes, no orders
- Hard 402 at 1 BOM / 100 lines / 3 analyses / 300 lines per month
- 1 concurrent job; 100 new MPN lookups/day/account
- Global Free Digi-Key intake: **400 lookups/day**; paid skips this queue
- Free-origin MPNs never enter daily sync unless a paid account has used that MPN
- 14-day TTL on BOM files and analyses, then delete
- Work email; 1 Free org per email domain; upload file cap 2 MB
- INFO logs only; no provider payload dumps
- Fargate desiredCount min=1 max=2

#	EXPLOSION	CONTROL
1	Debug logs / longer retention	Keep 1-day Fargate retention. Alarm ingest > 5 GB/day.
2	Bedrock on every line (esp. Sonnet)	LLM off on Free and until explicitly enabled on paid. Per-line token cap if enabled.
3	Uncapped Free unique-MPN fanout	Caps + 400/day Free intake + skip daily sync + paid-priority queue.
4	Fargate scale-out / oversize	min=1 max=2 until 50 paid accounts. Alarm RunningTaskCount > 2. Billing alarm \$150.
5	NAT + Amplify egress + versioned S3	Stay public-subnet. Expire noncurrent BOM versions at 30 days. No Amplify WAF until needed.

6. Cost snapshot (order of magnitude, USD)

Lights-on AWS ~\$50–100/mo (base ~\$70). One Growth subscriber covers baseline. AWS per analysis is cents. Stripe fee (~\$5 on \$149, ~\$12 on \$399) is the main paid COGS until Bedrock, debug logs, or uncapped Free. Mix assumed 50% Free / 40% Growth / 10% Scale. Not a bill.

N ACCOUNTS	GROSS REVENUE	INFRA+API COGS	STRIPE FEES	CONTRIBUTION	MARGIN
10 (5F · 4G · 1S)	\$996	~\$75	~\$30	~\$890	~90%
50 (25F · 20G · 5S)	\$4,975	~\$110	~\$154	~\$4,700	~95%
200 (100F · 80G · 20S)	\$19,900	~\$250	~\$617	~\$19,000	~96%
1,000 (500F · 400G · 100S)	\$99,500	~\$900	~\$3,055	~\$96,000	~96%

	FREE \$0	GROWTH \$149	SCALE \$399
Infra+API COGS (base)	\$0.10	~\$1	~\$3
Stripe	\$0	~\$5	~\$12
Contribution (base)	–\$0.10	~\$143	~\$384
Break-even vs \$70 lights-on	never	1 user	1 user

Free budget: ≤ \$1 variable/user/month. Proposed caps land ~\$0.10–0.50 AWS if LLM is off. Digi-Key quota binds before dollars. Uncapped Scale + Sonnet is the only plausible negative-margin path in this model.

7. Stripe (TEST) and entitlements

Keep (do not archive): Growth monthly price_1U4Mrn6OM1R4nep11h3o5N5N (\$149); Scale monthly price_1U4MsS6OM1R4nep1VdxKcCPb (\$399).

Create: growth_annual \$1,490/year (metadata plan=growth); scale_annual \$3,990/year (metadata plan=scale).

Do not create a Free product or price. Default plan=free when no active subscription. Checkout adds interval: month | year; refuse Free checkout. Wire STRIPE_PRICE_GROWTH_ANNUAL / STRIPE_PRICE_SCALE_ANNUAL; monthly env vars stay.

Enforce the JSON below on create_bom, analyze, quote, and order. Return 402 with {plan, cap, used, limit}. Period counters on the billing Dynamo item.

```
{
  "free": { "seats": 1, "active_boms": 1, "max_lines_per_bom": 100, "lines_per_month": 300, "analyses_per_month": 100 },
  "growth": { "seats": 2, "active_boms": 10, "max_lines_per_bom": 500, "lines_per_month": 2500, "analyses_per_month": 1000 },
  "scale": { "seats": 5, "active_boms": 50, "max_lines_per_bom": 2000, "lines_per_month": 15000, "analyses_per_month": 10000 }
}
```

8. Ship order and launch checklist

1. **Caps + paid-priority Digi-Key + Free sync exclusion + 402s.** Do not advertise Free until this is live.
2. **Annual Stripe prices + checkout interval.**
3. **Website pricing grid / real billing UI.**

ITEM	TODAY	REQUIRED FOR FREE LAUNCH
Per-tier quotas + 402s	Missing (only can_purchase)	Entitlements map on create/analyze/quote/order
can_purchase=false on Free	Already	Keep; no "taste of quotes"
Digi-Key 1,000/day limiter	In-process, global	Per-account + paid-priority + Free 400/day
Free parts skip daily sync	Missing	Sync only if a paid account used the MPN
CloudWatch 1-day retention	Already (Fargate)	Do not raise; audit payload logging
Fargate min 1 max 2	desiredCount=1, no ASG	Leave it; alarm RunningTaskCount > 2
AWS billing alarm \$100 / \$150 / \$250	Missing (BOM-write only)	Account estimated charges + SNS
S3 noncurrent expiry	Versioned, no lifecycle	Expire noncurrent at 30 days
1 Free org / domain	Self-signup, no cap	Work email; block disposable

9. 30-day metrics and red flags

Watch weekly. Decide on day 30. Do not change \$149 / \$399 during the experiment unless a red flag below fires.

Metrics

- Signups (accounts created)
- Free → paid conversion: $\geq 8\%$ of Free that ran ≥ 1 analysis
- Free cap-hit rate: **20–40%** of actives (too low = Free too fat)
- Analyses / active user (Free vs Growth)
- Lines / analysis (p50 / p90)
- AWS bill vs ~\$70 baseline
- Digi-Key / enrichment 429s and paid-queue wait
- Quote attempts on Free (succeeding should be ~0)
- Stripe: new Growth vs Scale; monthly vs annual

Red flags

Tighten Free immediately (do not wait 30 days): AWS bill >\$150 with <20 paid; Digi-Key 429s starving paid analyses; daily sync growing from Free-only MPNs; one domain burning the 400/day Free intake; Free users running 500+ line production BOMs via split files or re-signup.

Raise price only after 30 days: conversion >25% and paid users sitting >80% of caps without churn; Scale attaching with no push. **Do not raise** if conversion <5% — tighten Free and upgrade copy first.

Decision. This brief is locked. Implement entitlements and kill-switches, then annual Stripe, then the public grid. Pricing without caps is how TEST becomes an AWS/API incident.

Live deploy context (footnote): Gateway <http://prokuro-backend-2059790516.us-west-2.elb.amazonaws.com> · App <https://main.doue9i9pzude.amplifyapp.com> · Billing APIs live; Amplify Account UI still old mock until web billing push. · Architecture: us-west-2, 1× Fargate ARM64 512 CPU / 2048 MB, public subnet, ALB, Amplify SSR.